

Northwind Robotics

Travel & Expense Policy — Effective March 1, 2025

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy governs all business travel and associated expenses for Northwind Robotics employees and contractors. It supersedes the 2023 Travel Policy. Where this policy and the Employee Handbook differ on expense matters, this policy takes precedence.

2. Booking and Approval

All travel must be booked at least 14 days in advance through the corporate travel portal unless an exception is approved by a Director. Trips with a total estimated cost above 5,000 USD require Vice President approval before booking.

3. Class of Travel

Flight Duration	Permitted Class	Notes
Under 4 hours	Economy	No exceptions
4–8 hours	Premium Economy	Director approval to upgrade
Over 8 hours	Business	Available to all staff

Rail travel is preferred over air for any journey under 500 kilometers within Europe, in line with the company sustainability commitment described in the Sustainability Report.

4. Per-Diem Rates

Per-diem covers meals and incidentals. Lodging is reimbursed separately at actual cost against receipts. Rates by city tier:

City Tier	Example Cities	Daily Per-Diem
Tier 1	London, New York, Tokyo	85 USD
Tier 2	Berlin, Toronto, Austin	65 USD
Tier 3	All other locations	50 USD

Portland is classified as Tier 2 for the purpose of visiting employees from other offices.

5. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

- Personal entertainment such as movies, minibar, or spa services.
- Traffic fines, parking tickets, and vehicle towing charges.
- Travel insurance purchased separately (the company policy already covers all business travel).
- Airline lounge access, except for international trips over 8 hours.

6. Expense Submission

Expenses must be submitted within 30 days of the trip end date through Concur. The same 30-day rule and the 25 USD receipt threshold described in the Employee Handbook apply here. Reimbursement is processed in the next payroll cycle after manager approval, typically within 10 business days.

7. Mileage

Personal vehicle use for business is reimbursed at 0.67 USD per mile in the United States and 0.30 EUR per kilometer in the European Union. Mileage claims require the start and end addresses and the business purpose.

Policy owner: Finance Operations. Contact: travel@northwindrobotics.example.